

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

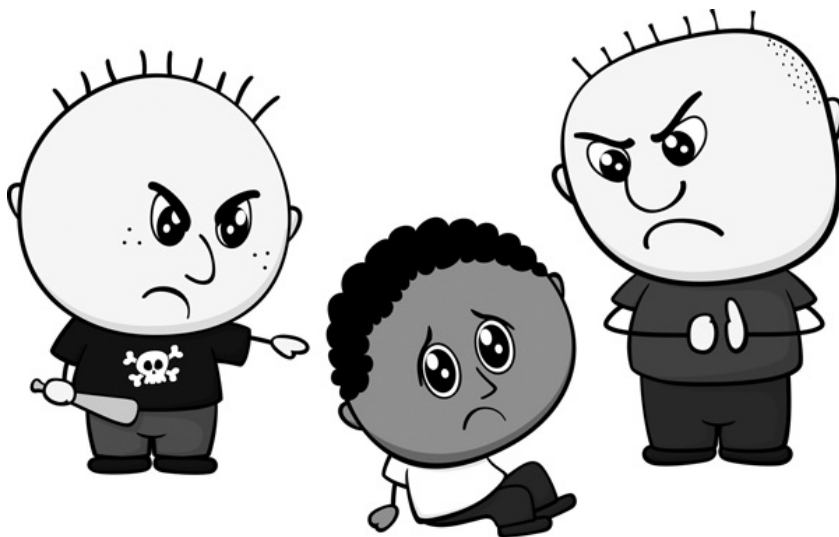
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Let's Start!

Stand up for your rights!



Learning Outcome

Describe the reasons or results of events or actions in spoken or written texts, in work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- Have you ever been treated badly by someone? If so, how did you deal with it?
- What cause or social group would you join to help social change?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about social issues, moral or personal dilemmas.
- I can talk about things that were happening.
- I can talk about interrupted events in the past.





Let's Explore!

In the days of Rosa Parks, African-Americans sat in the **colored section*** on buses.

* "Colored" is a derogatory term for African-American that is no longer used.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

It's hard to believe people in America did not have equal rights in the 1950's and that the Civil Rights Movement, and people like Rosa Parks had to fight for justice. One December evening in 1955, Rosa Parks was riding the bus after she finished a day at work as a dressmaker. She was sitting in the "colored section" when the bus stopped to let more passengers on. When the bus driver ordered all African-American passengers to give up their seats for the white people, everybody complied except Rosa Parks, who was not only exhausted and sore after a day's work, but determined to keep her seat. After she refused to give up her seat, she was arrested and fined. The incident led to the famous Montgomery boycott in which citizens collectively refused to take the buses until the law was changed.

Before Rosa was arrested, two other women challenged the same law. It was because Rosa was courageous and well-respected that she was able to draw enough attention to the incident and gain white support.

As the lawsuits were making their way up to the Supreme Court, Montgomery's white citizens were becoming violent and angry. The boycotters persisted and gained media attention. Finally, bus segregation was ruled unconstitutional on November 13th, 1956. Despite this success, Rosa was being harassed and threatened, so she and her family moved to Detroit, where she became an administrative aide.

It is not surprising that Rosa Parks is known as the "mother of the Civil Rights Movement."





Let's Practice!

What was happening at the time?

Instructions: Select all the correct answers.

Which of these sentences refer to things that were happening?

- ☐ 1. As the lawsuits were making their way up to the Supreme Court, Montgomery's white citizens were becoming violent and angry.
- ☐ 2. Despite this success, Rosa was being harassed and threatened, so she and her family moved to Detroit where she became an administrative aide.
- ☐ 3. She was sitting in the "colored section" when the bus stopped to let more passengers on.
- ☐ 4. The boycotters persisted and gained media attention.
- ☐ 5. It's hard to believe people in America did not have equal rights in the 1950's.
- ☐ 6. Rosa Parks was determined to keep her seat.
- ☐ 7. One December evening in 1955, Rosa Parks was riding the bus after she finished a day at work as a dressmaker.
- ☐ 8. It is not surprising that Rosa Parks is known as the "mother of the Civil Rights Movement."



Let's Practice!

Thank goodness for people like Rosa Parks!

Instructions: Complete the sentences with the options in the Word Bank. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

Word Bank

dressmaker / well-respected / to draw enough attention / collectively / justice / boycott / unconstitutional

1. The Civil Rights Movement and people like Rosa Parks had to fight for _____.
2. Rosa Parks worked as a _____.
3. It was because Rosa was courageous and _____ that she was able _____ to the incident and gain white support.
4. Finally, bus segregation was ruled _____ on November 13th, 1956.
5. During the famous Montgomery _____, citizens _____ refused to take the buses.





Extension Activity

Watch *Selma*.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Find the film *Selma* and watch it.
- Take notes on the key events in the plot.
- Write a summary of the movie using interrupted events and events that were happening.
- Read your summary to someone.
- Discuss the issues raised in the film.

Self-Assessment

Yes No

I watch a film about social issues.

☐ ☐

I write notes on key events.

☐ ☐

I write about things that were happening and about interrupted events.

☐ ☐

I read my summary aloud.

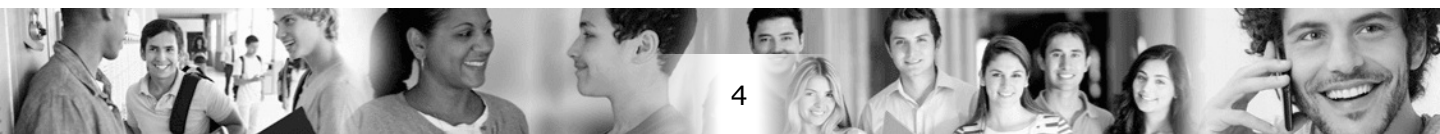
☐ ☐

I discuss the issues from the film with a friend.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- dressmaker** (noun): a person whose job is making women's clothes
e.g. One December evening in 1955, Rosa Parks was riding the bus after she finished a day at work as a dressmaker.
- unconstitutional** (adjective): not in accordance with a political constitution
e.g. Finally, bus segregation was ruled unconstitutional on November 13th, 1956.
- collectively** (adverb): as a group
e.g. The incident led to the famous Montgomery Boycott in which citizens collectively refused to take the buses until the law was changed.
- well-respected** (adjective): admired by many
e.g. It was because Rosa was courageous and well-respected that she was able to draw enough attention to the incident and gain white support.
- to draw attention** (expression): to cause people to focus on something or someone
e.g. It was because Rosa was courageous and well-respected that she was able to draw enough attention to the incident and gain white support.
- to harass** (verb): to annoy or trouble someone repeatedly
e.g. Rosa was being harassed and threatened so she and her family moved to Detroit, where she became an administrative aide.
- boycott** (verb): to withdraw from commercial or social relations as a form of punishment or protest
e.g. The incident led to the famous Montgomery Boycott in which citizens collectively refused to take the buses until the law was changed.





Learning Points

Past Continuous Tense

You can use the past continuous to talk about events that were in progress at a time in the past.

To form the past continuous, you need:

be (was/were) + present participle (verb -ing)

Remember that you do not usually use continuous verb tenses with stative verbs. These are verbs that show thoughts, emotions and states. Some of these verbs include *like, love, hate, want, need, think, understand, be* and *have* (for possession).

- NOT: *I was liking the chocolate cake at the restaurant.*
- *I **liked** the chocolate cake at the restaurant.*
- NOT: *I was having a car in 2003.*
- *I **had** a car in 2003.*

You can use the past continuous to talk about actions that were happening at a specific time in the past.

- *I **was making** breakfast at 7 a.m. yesterday morning.*

The emphasis when you use the past continuous is on the progress of the action. This verb tense does not say that the action has been completed.

- *I **was writing** an essay last night.*
- (This emphasizes the duration of the action. As this verb tense does not describe a finished action, it suggests that the essay was not finished.)
- *It **was snowing** all night.*
- (The focus is on the duration of the event and that there was snow throughout the night.)

Compare this to the use of the simple past:

- *I **wrote** an essay last night.*
- (I finished the entire essay last night from the beginning to the end.)
- *It **snowed** all night.*
- (The event was one complete event and it snowed from the beginning to the end of the night.)

If you want to talk about two actions that were happening at the same time, you can use **while** with the past continuous.

- *I **was doing** work on the computer while my aunt **was cleaning** the kitchen.*

You can use **all evening, all night, all weekend**, and other adverbials with **all** to show that an action was in progress during this time.

- *I **was cooking** all day yesterday.*
- ***Were** you **exercising** all morning?*





Learning Points

Examples:

- *One December evening in 1955, Rosa Parks was riding the bus after she finished a day at work as a dressmaker.*
- *She was sitting in the "colored section" when the bus stopped to let more passengers on.*

Time Clause: Interrupted Events

You can use the past continuous tense with different time words to show that an action was interrupted.

You can use the past continuous with the simple past to show that an action interrupted another action in the past.

The action in the continuous tense is the action that was happening when another action (in the simple past) occurred.

*They **were watching** a movie when the lights went out.
When the lights went out, they **were watching** a movie.*

(past continuous + when + simple past for the interrupting action)

*While I **was chopping up** the vegetables for dinner, I cut myself.
I cut myself while I **was chopping up** the vegetables for dinner.*

(while + past continuous + simple past for the interrupting action)

You can put either clause first, but remember to use a comma after the time clause (with **when** or **while** as in the examples above).

If you want to talk about order of events, you can use **after**, **before** and **until**.

*I washed the blood off my finger **before** I put on a Band-Aid.
I continued chopping vegetables **after** I bandaged my finger.
The Band-Aid stayed on my finger **until** I took a shower and it fell off.*

Examples:

- *After she refused to give up her seat, she was arrested and fined.*
- *The incident led to the famous Montgomery boycott in which citizens collectively refused to take the buses until the law was changed.*
- *Before Rosa was arrested, two other women challenged the same law.*

